

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

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Vance Sets Iran Terms

- In an exclusive interview, Vice President JD Vance said any deal to end the war requires Iran to make a meaningful cut to its nuclear enrichment capacity, not just promises of future drawdowns, asking: "If you don't want a nuclear weapon, then why do you need 60% enriched fuel?" — [Reuters](#)
- Vance confirmed President Trump rejected Tehran's latest offer, said Washington is unsure how Iran makes decisions, disclosed that he had brokered a provisional September peace agreement that quickly fell apart, and warned military operations could intensify after the midterms. — [Reuters](#)
- Separately on Tuesday, Trump said nobody knew who was running Iran during the U.S.-Israeli war with Iran, now in its eighth month, echoing Vance's uncertainty about Tehran's decision-making. — [Reuters](#)
- At a Nebraska rally Monday night, Trump said wartime price rises were "a small price to pay," that Iran could "take out a city" but the war was "essentially almost over," adding "Let 'em take out Los Angeles" — comments California Governor Newsom called "deranged and dangerous." The White House said Tuesday he meant the U.S. had fought to stop Iran gaining that ability. — [Reuters](#)

Tanker Struck: On Peace Named

- India's foreign ministry said Tuesday the Panama-flagged oil tanker MT On Peace was struck by an unknown projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz on Monday — the engine-room-fire incident UKMTO logged as Warning 156-26 without naming the vessel. Twelve of the 19 crew were injured, 11 of them Indian nationals; the injured were evacuated with Omani assistance and are being treated in Khasab, Oman. India condemned the attack and called for an immediate cessation of such incidents. — [Reuters](#)
- The tanker is managed by Anglo-Eastern Tanker Management Hong Kong and was last seen discharging fuel oil at Fujairah in August with its transponder switched off, according to Kpler tracking data. — [Reuters](#)

Saudi Airports Hit

- Saudi Arabia's aviation authority said Monday evening that two attacks targeted King Abdullah Bin Abdulaziz International Airport in Jazan and Najran International Airport, injuring three people and causing limited damage; damage is being assessed and passenger-safety measures were taken. — [Reuters](#)
- The attacks came as Saudi-backed Yemeni forces pressed a major offensive to retake Houthi-held ground near Bab el-Mandeb, with the Houthis responding with missile and drone attacks on Saudi airports, oil facilities and military sites. Houthi claims of strikes on Riyadh's airport and the Rabigh refinery remain unconfirmed. — [Reuters](#)

Fairford Drone Plot

- Two U.S. officials told Reuters on Tuesday that a suspected Iranian drone-plot threat led the United States to remove all its B-1 bombers from RAF Fairford, Britain's preferred European base for U.S. bombers; Iran denies any involvement. — [Reuters](#)
- British counter-terrorism police arrested a 22-year-old British man in Westminster on Tuesday on suspicion of preparation of terrorist acts — the seventh arrest in the Fairford investigation. The Wall Street Journal reported that a branch of Iran's Revolutionary Guard planned to recruit British citizens to carry out a drone-swarm attack on the base with a diversion nearby. — [The Times](#)
- Trump said Monday the withdrawal of a dozen bombers was a direct response to a specific threat: "They didn't fly out by accident. There were some threats." Six suspects arrested earlier, including a dual British-Iranian national, have been released on bail. — [The Times](#)

FlyDubai Probe Widens

- Australia's Victorian Joint Counter Terrorism Team — federal police, Victoria police and the domestic intelligence service — is investigating the Australia links of FlyDubai co-pilot suspect Hamam al-Hammami, 29, who studied mechanical engineering at RMIT in Melbourne from 2015 to 2017 without completing the degree. — [The Times](#)
- No official investigation has publicly established an Iranian link to the September 30 attack on FlyDubai flight FZ1073; the inquiry continues into the suspect's motives and any outside links. — [The Times](#)

Markets

- Brent crude settled at \$101.18 a barrel on October 6. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- WTI settled at \$89.97 a barrel on October 6. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The U.S. national average diesel price was \$6.199 a gallon on October 5, per the EIA weekly reading. — [Reuters](#)
- UK NBP natural gas day-ahead was 179.027 pence a therm on October 5. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- VLCC day rates on Middle East routes recently exceeded \$1.2 million a day, up from roughly \$30,000 a day in January, per shipping broker Poten & Partners. — [Reuters](#)

Shipping

- Middle East crude exports averaged 18.5 million barrels a day in the seven days to October 1 — above the 18 million barrel pre-war average — per Kpler ship-tracking data; the figure covers all regional exports, not Hormuz alone, and excludes vessels that may have crossed with AIS transponders off. — [Reuters](#)

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